

COURSES OF ACTION - Analytical Reasoning

COURSES OF ACTION

Directions: In each question below is given a statement followed by two courses of action numbered I and II. A course of action is a step or administrative decision to be taken for improvement, Follow-up or further action in regard to the problem, policy, etc. On the basis of the information given in the statement, you have to be true, then decide which of the suggested courses of action logically follow (s) for pursuing.

Give answer (1) if only course of action I follows.

Give answer (2) if only course of action II follows.

Give answer (3) if either course of action I or II follows.

Give answer (4) if neither course of action I nor II follows.

Give answer (5) if both courses of action I and II follows.

1. Statement: There have been sporadic cases of stone throwing and damaging vehicles in the locality during the day following altercation between two local youth clubs last night.

Courses of action

I. The local police administration should arrest all those who are caught committing these acts.

II. The local police administration should call a meeting of office bearers of both the clubs of the locality to bring the situation under control.

2. Statement: A huge truck over turned on the middle of the main road and blocked most part of the road causing a huge traffic jam.

Courses of action

I. The traffic department should immediately deploy its personnel to divert traffic through other roads.

II. The traffic department should immediately send men and equipment to move the truck and clear the road.

3. Statement: Some workers of the company making diamond jewellery were caught while they were leaving the premises as they were trying to smuggle small pieces of diamonds hidden in their purses.

Courses of action

I. The management of the company should immediately put on hold all activities in the premises till a fool proof security system is in place.

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II. The belongings of all the workers should thoroughly be searched before should they leave the premises of the company.

4. Statement: A huge tidal wave swept away many fishing boats and hutments of the Fishermen living along the coastline.

Courses of action

I. The fishermen should henceforth be restrained from constructing their huts along the coast line.

II. The local administration should send a team of officials to assess the extent of damage and suggest remedial measures.

5. Statement: A large number of invitees who attended the marriage function fell ill due to food poisoning and were rushed to various hospitals located in the area.

Courses of action

I. The government should ban such marriage functions till further notice.

II. The local hospitals should be advised by the government to provide best service to the affected people.

6. Statement: An increasing number of farmers prefer to avail loans from local money lenders instead of the banks owing to complicated paperwork involved in banks.

Courses of action:

I. Local moneylenders who charge interest rates lower than the banks should be punished.

II. Banks should simplify the procedure to avail loans so as to suit the farmers.

7. Statement: A major river in the city was reduced to a polluted and dirty canal after tonnes of sewage made way into it over the years.

Courses of action

I. All those who dumped garbage and sewage into the river should be penalized.

II. The government should modify the sewage system and find an alternate way to dump city's waste.

8. Statement: Water table in most parts of the State has gone down to such a level that its extraction for irrigation purposes is not economical any more.

Courses of Action:

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I. Extraction of ground water for any purpose in the State should be banned for some time in order to replenish the water table.

II. The government should make provisions for alternative methods of irrigation so that the farmers are not compelled to use ground water.

9. Statement: A university librarian reported increased cases of theft of books from the library.

Courses of Action:

I. Stricter security arrangements should be put in place in order to prevent such incidents.

II. All the students in the university should be made to pay a hefty fine in order to replace the lost books.

10. Statement: Indigenous tribes living near Amazon forests are cutting down trees to cover their basic needs, thus severely affecting the ecological balance in the area.

Courses of action:

I. All the tribes living near the Amazon rain forests should be forced to shift to urban areas of the Country.

II. The tribes should be allowed to continue doing so as they cut down trees for their basic and not for commercial purposes.

11. Statement: Many over-qualified professionals are now opting for lower ranked jobs owing to recession in the market which has made new recruitments almost nil in the recent months.

Courses of action:

I. Over qualified people should not be allowed to undertake jobs which do not suit their academic qualifications.

II. Such candidates should be encouraged to postpone undertaking a job until recession subsides.

12. Statement: In a mock security drill at the airport, a passenger ignored the instructions of the crew and severely injured his leg while hurrying to get off the plane.

Courses of action:

I. The passenger should sue the airline for negligence.

II. The airline should provide immediate medical assistance to the passenger.

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13. Statement: Illegal construction in the area which attracts thousands of tourists every year has been leading to frequent landslides and floods.

Courses of action:

- I. The Government should put a ban on all kinds of construction work in the area.
- II. Tourism in the area should be totally banned until illegal construction work stops completely.

14. Statement: Imported fruits which are priced at nearly thrice the regular price have been flooding the market, making fruits out of reach for a middle class house hold.

Courses of action:

- I. The Government should regulate the prices of fruits so as to make them affordable to the common man.
- II. Indian farmers should be encouraged to grow the imported varieties of fruit as these are more popular among the general public.

15. Statement: Many complaints have been registered lately by commuters regarding unavailability of railway tickets during the peak travelling season.

Courses of action:

- I. The commuters should be advised to defer their travel plans till the peak season gets over.
- II. Railways should try to accommodate as many commuters as possible by adding extra coaches to the trains.

16. Statement: Leader of a tribal community residing near a proposed highway project has given an application expressing his community's opposition to construction of the highway through their residential area.

Courses of action:

- I. Government should convince the tribal community stating the fact that building of the highway would bring development in their area.
- II. Government should immediately stall the highway project in response to the resistance faced by the tribal community.

17. Statement: More and more farmers have been shifting to cultivation of export quality rice rather than the rice eaten daily by people as export quality rice helps them earn more profit.

Courses of action:

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- I. Strict action should be taken against the farmers growing only export quality rice in their fields.
- II. Procurement price of other qualities of rice should be increased so as to make their cultivation a profitable venture as well.

18. Statement: According to a recent report, almost 90% students from a premier college in India end up settling in foreign countries for nearly thrice the salary drawn in India.

Courses of action

- I. Indian organisations should pay salaries to students from this college which are at par with the foreign organisations.
- II. Signing of a bond which prevents them from taking a job in any foreign country should be made mandatory by the government.

19. Statement: The police reported that two armed terrorists had entered the city a couple of days ago.

Courses of action:

- I. Police should immediately circulate the photographs of the terrorists using electronic and print media in order to take public's help in nabbing them.
- II. Public should be informed to stay indoors until the terrorists are arrested.

20. Statement: The sales of ballpoint pens manufactured by company Lixus have gone down considerably ever since the same company introduced a gel-ink pen in the market.

Courses of action:

- I. Ball point pens should not be manufactured by Lixus anymore.
- II. Lixus should immediately withdraw all gel-ink pens from the market so as to force people to buy ball-point pens.

21. Statement: Nearly 26 per cent of all engineering graduates have been left unemployed owing to severe recession worldwide.

Course of Action

- I. All the unemployed students should be advised to take up jobs in foreign countries.
- II. The unemployed students should be advised to take up jobs only after the recession is over.

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22. Statement: The government airline has been making huge losses even as private airliners continue to prosper and make substantial profit.

Courses of action

- I. All the private airlines should be banned from their operation in the country.
- II. The government airlines should be instructed to increase passenger fare significantly in order to increase its profit.

23. Statement: Many private schools have been violating government directives and have been charging more fees than the specified limits.

Courses of action

- I. The government should identify such schools and take stringent actions against them.
- II. The government should not limit school fees and keep it flexible for the schools to decide.

24. Statement: A large number of patients admitted in a particular hospital have been diagnosed with a serious contagious disease.

Courses of action

- I. These patients should be immediately evicted from the hospital for fear of spread of the disease.
- II. The hospital should make appropriate quarantine arrangements to control the spread of disease.

25. Statement: Despite all the efforts by the government, thirty cases of polio were reported in State X as the parents of those children remained uninformed of this drive against polio.

Courses of Action:

- I. Strict action should be taken against the parents of children affected from polio.
- II. Strict action should be taken against the doctors administering polio drops in the state.

26. Statement: Private airliners have increased the fare during festive season by almost 50%.

Courses of action

- I. People should be advised to travel only by buses and trains during the festive season.
- II. Airfares should be regulated by the government to a certain limit.

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27. Statement: Several passengers were stranded at the airport as all the flights had to be cancelled due to severe snowfall for the third consecutive day.

- I. All the flights should be immediately resumed.
- II. Airport authority should provide appropriate stay arrangements for the stranded passengers.

28. Statement: A practice march by the Army is scheduled to be held on one of the busiest roads in the city on Tuesday.

Courses of action:

- I. Traffic should be diverted during the practice march so as to ease traffic congestion during that time.
- II. Public notices should be issued to avoid using the road till the practice march on Tuesday gets over.

29. Statement: Very few students have been opting for academic research as professional dividends.

Courses of action:

- I. Academic research should be linked to industry so as to improve its economic perspective.
- II. Economic dividends of professional courses should be made less attractive so as to attract students to academic research as well.

30. Statement: People see tax as a burden and thus devise ways to underpay or avoid it altogether.

Courses of action:

- I. Government should educate and inform citizens about the ways in which taxes help in development of the nation.
- II. Tax rates should be increased so that the under-recovery in collection is compensated.

31. Statement: There is no motivation among today's generation to join the armed forces owing to frequent transfers to risky areas. Perhaps they are not aware of the good side of it.

Courses of action:

- I. Short term internship should be introduced at high school level to give students a peek into the adventurous life of the forces and provide a more realistic job purview.
- II. The salary levels of the defence forces should be increased with immediate effect.

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32. Statement: A plethora of bodies with no single one which can be held accountable for city's development is the key reason behind its rather stagnant state.

Courses of action:

- I. Each body should be given a set of duties and there should be no duplication in such allocation.
- II. An umbrella committee should be appointed with powers to regulate actions of all other bodies.

33. Statement: Number of hospital beds per 10000 people in India, which is a key indicator of healthcare infrastructure, is much lower than many other nations which are thought to be poorer than India.

Courses of action:

- I. The expenditure of importing costly medicines should be borne by the state.
- II. Incentives should be given to encourage entry of private players into building of healthcare infrastructure.

Answers:

- 1. (2) Only course of action II seems to be appropriate.
- 2. (5) Clearly both the courses action are suitable for pursuing.
- 3. (2) Only course of action II seems to be appropriate for pursuing.
- 4. (5) Both the courses of action are appropriate for pursuing.
- 5. (4) None follows as it is the understood duty of the hospitals to provide best services always to the affected people so government intervention isn't required.
- 6. (2) Only course of action II seems to be appropriate for pursuing.
- 7. (2) Course of action I is not feasible practically. Only, Course of action II seems to be appropriate.

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8. (5) Clearly both the courses action are suitable for pursuing.
9. (1) Only course of action I seems to be appropriate.
10. (4) Neither of courses of action seems to be suitable for pursuing.
11. (4) None of the courses of action is suitable for pursuing.
12. (2) Only course of action II is suitable for pursuing.
13. (4) None of the courses of action is suitable for pursuing.
14. (5) Both courses of action are suitable for pursuing.
15. (2) Only course of action II seems to be appropriate.
16. (1) Only course of action I seems to be suitable.
17. (2) Only course of action II seems to be suitable.
18. (4) None of the courses of action seems to be suitable.
19. (1) Only course of action I seems to be suitable.
20. (4) None of the courses of action is suitable for pursuing. If the company Lixus would not manufacture Ball point pens, some other company may introduce Ball point pens in the market. Similarly, some other company may introduce gel-ink pens in the market.
21. (4) As the recession is worldwide employment scenario in other countries would also have adversely affected. Therefore, course of action I is not suitable for pursuing. Course of action II lacks practical approach.

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22. (4) None of the courses of action is suitable for pursuing.
23. (1) Only course of action I seems to be suitable for pursuing.
24. (2) Only course of action II is suitable for pursuing.
25. (4) None of the courses of action is feasible practically. Parents of such children should be motivated to take benefits of pulse polio drive. The use of term 'strict' in both the courses of action makes them invalid.
26. (2) Course of action I seems to be an advice. Therefore, only course of action II seems to be appropriate.
27. (4) None follows as it is not the responsibility of the airport authority to look into the alternate arrangements. Instead, the respective airlines should be instructed to do so.
28. (5) Obviously, Both courses of action are appropriate.
29. (1) Only course of action I seems to be appropriate.
30. (1) Only course of action I seems to be suitable for pursuing.
31. (1) Salary is not mentioned here as a concern so it may be possible that people are not willing to join in spite of the high salaries as their main concern is the transfer to risky areas.
32. (5) Obviously, Both courses of action are suitable.
33. (2) Only course of action II is suitable.